

Joint Heirs With Christ

I was attempting to finish Romans 7 and 8, Galatians, and our understanding of adoption: how the covenant God made with Abraham, when fulfilled, resulted in our adoption.

Paul says:

"If ye be Christ's,
then are ye Abraham's seed,
and heirs according to the promise."

The covenant God cut with Abraham resulted in our adoption. Our spirits went from death to life, and we became sons and daughters of God.

This New Testament is a new will. Once you inherit, you become the beneficiary of the will. I no longer stand outside the will trying to earn it; I have inherited and become a son. My full inheritance is through sonship.

Romans 8 says:

"And if children, then heirs;
heirs of God,
and joint-heirs with Christ."

The more I understand that this is my inheritance, the more excited I get. An inheritance is something you receive because you are a son, not something you earn.

When God laid the Born-Again Trail out to me in my office, I did not know how deeply this would sink in. He said that when I understood what had happened to me, everything the Word of God said I could have, I would have. Everything He promised in the way of His call and power could be mine.

Now I understand why He put us on the Born-Again Trail. Some of these things I do not think I would ever have entered into if He had not opened this revelation.

But anyone who prays in tongues has access to revelation. By your own choice and will, whenever you pray in the Holy Ghost, you are making the Holy Spirit your Teacher.

Maybe I did not fully understand that in my first twenty years of ministry, but I intend to understand it in the next twenty.

Hebrews 1:1-2 says:

"God, who at sundry times
and in divers manners
spake in time past unto the fathers by the prophets,
hath in these last days spoken unto us by his Son,
whom he hath appointed heir of all things,
by whom also he made the worlds."

I like that: He appointed Him heir. You and I were quickened together with Him. He is the Firstborn from the dead, which means there was no one before Him in that category. Adam was born of God, but not firstborn from the dead; he had never been dead until he died.

Jesus is the Firstborn from the dead, the Firstborn among many brethren.

What about Moses, Abraham, and the Old Testament saints? They are in heaven now, but they had to wait in the Old Testament place of comfort called Abraham's bosom.

That does not mean they lived inside Abraham's rib cage. It means they were embraced in the center of the promises God made to Abraham, especially righteousness through faith.

Before the law, they waited on the promise God made to Abraham. After the law, they still waited for the coming of Jesus. Even Job, who did not know Abraham, said:

"I know that my redeemer liveth,
and that he shall stand at the latter day upon the earth."

When you understand the Born-Again Trail, verses like that begin to clear up.

Jesus said that among those born of women there was no greater prophet than John the Baptist, yet the least in the Kingdom of heaven is greater than he.

How could He say that? John did no miracles. He was a voice crying in the wilderness, sent to reveal Jesus: "This is He." He was the forerunner, preparing hearts and declaring that One greater than he would baptize with the Holy Ghost and fire.

John was greatest because he revealed Jesus. Yet his revelation was limited because his spirit had not yet been born again. The least person in the Kingdom, born again and made a son of God, has the capacity to understand more than John had before the cross.

John is a son now, but before the new birth was made available, even his greatness had that limitation.

Jesus told Peter:

"Satan hath desired to have you,
that he may sift you as wheat:
but I have prayed for thee,
that thy faith fail not:
and when thou art converted,
strengthen thy brethren."

That conversion was the time between the cross, the resurrection, and the coming of the Holy Spirit. Jesus also said of the Comforter:

"He dwelleth with you,
and shall be in you."

Before the human spirit was born again, the Holy Spirit could only be with them for the purposes, pursuits, and plans of God. He ministered to the soul, but He could not take up residence in a born-again spirit until redemption was accomplished.

Jesus told the Samaritan woman:

"The hour cometh, and now is,
when the true worshippers shall worship the Father
in spirit and in truth:
for the Father seeketh such to worship him."

That hour had not existed before. The generation she lived in was the hour because Jesus' feet were on the earth. On the millennial time clock, an hour is roughly a generation. He was saying, "The hour now is. I am here. I am going to die, rise, and you will be born again."

Worship in spirit does not mean a mystical takeover by the Holy Spirit. It means worship from a regenerated human spirit. Old Testament men could not worship that way because they were spiritually dead.

For four thousand years, men were locked outside God's nature by spiritual death. The Father had sought such worship and waited for it. Now He could reach into a born-again spirit, pull a man into His bosom, and fellowship with him as a son.

We can know Him in a way no Old Testament saint could know Him. We can crawl up into the bosom of the Father, worship Him, and walk as sons and daughters.

God had to administer law because unregenerated men must be governed by law. Any nation not born again has to be under law. The only way to control a spiritually dead nature is to discipline it by law.

When Israel refused to administrate the law, another nation would come and administrate judgment over them. That is hard to believe, but those judgments were acts of love in this sense: God had to protect the bloodline, the seed. If He did not protect the seed, no one would be saved.

Spiritually dead men form clans, defend themselves, conquer, and are conquered. When a stronger man rises, he becomes a Hitler, Stalin, Lenin, Napoleon, or Alexander. That is the nature of spiritual death.

God had fellowship with Israel's faith, obedience, and shadows, but not the born-again fellowship of a regenerated spirit. That is why the new birth changes everything.

God would not let me live in the Old Testament for quite a while. I could read it, of course, but He would not let me spend my major meditation time there until I understood the Born-Again Trail.

I spent time in the Old Testament verses that New Testament teachers used when God revealed Jesus to them, such as Paul's quotations in Hebrews. I devoured those because I knew they were part of the revelation of Jesus used to establish the canon of Scripture.

Without that understanding, you can twist Old Testament examples to serve your flesh. The Old Testament saints were spiritually dead. Solomon, for example, came very close to the true under the shadow, yet he had hundreds of wives and concubines, and God was angry with him. It was not right.

John says of Jesus:

"He whom God hath sent speaketh the words of God:
for God giveth not the Spirit by measure unto him."

Many teachers use that to say we can never have what Jesus had. But the Born-Again Trail shows what John is saying. Jesus could receive the Spirit without measure because He was the first Man in four thousand years to stand on earth with a spiritually alive human spirit. He was the first Man since Adam whom God could fill with the Holy Spirit.

Old Testament prophets received the Spirit by measure for a purpose, pursuit, or plan. That operation touched their soul for a period of time and then lifted.

But not you. You are born again. The Holy Spirit stepped into you. Even though you have a measured call in the Body, you do not have the Holy Spirit by measure. You have as much of Him as you will yield to.

Being full of the Holy Spirit does not mean one believer has more of the Person of the Holy Spirit than another. We received a Person. Being full means the flesh is yielded, false doctrine is not unseating Him, deception is not closing the gate, and more of Him can flow out.

Some believers will be embarrassed in heaven to find they had the power to imprison the Holy Spirit in their part of the world.

The whole book of Romans is a masterpiece. The Jew struggled to understand how Gentiles, especially swine-eating Gentiles, could step into the same inheritance without keeping the law. To go from being chosen to sitting at the same table with a Gentile calling your God "Father" was difficult for them.

Thank God for Paul. He fought that war and left us the canon of Scripture so we could understand how free we are.

Hebrews says God has spoken to us in these last days by His Son, whom He appointed heir of all things. We have been quickened together with Him and seated in heavenly places. I am an heir of God and a joint heir with Christ.

That means one resurrected, glorified body has been put on my account because He has already risen. Meanwhile, I have full inheritance in my spirit to carry out the ministry of reconciliation: healing, peace, and all the provision it takes to take this Kingdom away from the devil.

Hebrews 2 quotes Psalm 8:

"What is man,
that thou art mindful of him?
or the son of man,
that thou visitest him?"

David saw the question, but Hebrews reveals the answer:

"But we see Jesus,
who was made a little lower than the angels
for the suffering of death,
crowned with glory and honour;
that he by the grace of God
should taste death for every man."

God's mind was full of man in his fallen state, so He visited him through the Son of Man. Jesus was made lower than the angels for the suffering of death, then crowned with glory and honor.

He had to dip into death so you and I could come aboard and He could take us out.

Hebrews continues:

"For it became him,
for whom are all things,
and by whom are all things,
in bringing many sons unto glory,
to make the captain of their salvation
perfect through sufferings."

As the Captain of salvation, He piloted us through death first.

Hebrews 2:11 says:

"For both he that sanctifieth
and they who are sanctified
are all of one:
for which cause he is not ashamed
to call them brethren."

The born-again experience and my adoption did such a thorough work, bringing my spirit from death to life, that Jesus is not ashamed to call me His brother.

But do not get foolish. We are brothers of Jesus' glorified humanity, not His deity. He is the only One whose glorified humanity is also deity. We will never evolve into His deity, contrary to some doctrines.

The Ark of the Covenant pictured this: gopher wood overlaid with gold. The wood represented humanity; the gold represented deity. Thank God I am a brother of His glorified humanity. I have one resurrected body laid to my account. Meanwhile, my inheritance and I are going to tear up hell and take many people home.

Hebrews quotes:

"I will declare thy name unto my brethren,
in the midst of the church will I sing praise unto thee."

It also says:

"Behold I and the children which God hath given me."

Psalms 8 says:

"Out of the mouth of babes and sucklings
hast thou ordained strength
because of thine enemies."

Jesus referred to this in Matthew 21 when children cried, "Hosanna," in the temple and the Pharisees were angry. He said:

"Out of the mouth of babes and sucklings
thou hast perfected praise."

That perfected praise from the new nature is the ordained strength that stills the enemy and the avenger. We are His brethren, and yet He also says, "I and the children God has given Me."

Hebrews 2:14-16 says:

"Forasmuch then as the children are partakers of flesh and blood,
he also himself likewise took part of the same;
that through death he might destroy him
that had the power of death,
that is, the devil;
and deliver them who through fear of death
were all their lifetime subject to bondage."

The devil had the power of death through the unregenerated nature. He could reign through that nature and move men into bondage. Jesus tasted spiritual death and delivered us from that bondage and fear.

He did not take on the nature of angels; He took on the seed of Abraham.

Every angel was created by Jesus:

"All things were made by him;
and without him was not any thing made that was made."

We do not know when He created them, but before anything had a beginning, He existed. He was the Creator in the Godhead. The Father appears as Planner, the Holy Spirit as Regenerator, and the Son as Creator.

Some faith teachers have said Satan has no redemption because Adam had a tempter and Satan did not. That sounds good until you remember that a third of the angels followed Satan. They had a tempter too. So why no redemption for them?

The angels came into existence fully formed, in the presence of the fullness of God's glory. Satan led a rebellion, and those angels followed him. The other archangels did not simply stand by. Those angels had decisions to make. They turned with Satan against God and against God's creation.

Adam was tempted and fell, but after the fall he did not turn to destroy God's creation. He turned toward the plan God made and was ultimately saved when Jesus rose from the dead.

We did not ask to be born. We were born spiritually dead, products of a fallen race. Of course God provided a Redeemer for us. We were totally unaccountable for being born into that condition.

Romans 5:12 says:

"Wherefore, as by one man sin entered into the world,
and death by sin;
and so death passed upon all men,
for that all have sinned."

Some teach that children are born spiritually alive and later fall to sin at the age of accountability. But Romans 5:12-14 is one thought.

Until the law, sin was in the world, but sin is not imputed where there is no law. Nevertheless, death reigned from Adam to Moses, even over those who had not sinned after the similitude of Adam's transgression.

Adam had a direct commandment: do not eat of that tree. He transgressed. But from Adam to Moses there was no law in that same sense, and still spiritual death reigned. Why? Because they were born spiritually dead.

That is the condition Jesus came to redeem.